Practical – Digital transformation of MH4U mental health charity

For this practical class, it is important that you continue to work together as a group using the skills and techniques that you gained from the earlier workshops on an 'Introduction to Design Thinking, Ideation and Cocreation' to ideate and cocreate your product or service solution, be it for example a device or an app or a combination of the two, that meets the allocated Sustainable Development Goal (SDG) for this year of 'Good Health and Wellbeing', as well as utilising Miro.

Background

Mental Health for You (MH4U), a charity based in Northern Ireland, currently works with individuals, families, organisations, and youth groups. Services are available for all age groups, including counselling and therapeutic services. Groups and corporations can take advantage of training and educational programs to raise awareness and understanding of mental health issues. This includes specialised programs which focus on promoting mental and emotional wellbeing through early intervention and prevention strategies. Services offered to clients include employment and training services, while allowing for socialisation and a sense of community through non-vocational group sessions.

This charity plays a key role in supporting the mental wellbeing of individuals and communities within Northern Ireland by providing these essential services. MH4U works closely with the government and other charities to raise awareness and advocate for improved mental health support systems. MH4U employs over 200 staff, and any digital solution needs to accommodate their needs.

In order to fortify its position in the mental health landscape, MH4U should enrich its value proposition by promoting a holistic approach that takes into account diverse stakeholder needs and expectations. Market analysis has revealed the growing demand for digital mental health services to cater to a diverse range of mental health needs. Your task in this practical is to identify the key functions of a new digital mental health platform for MH4U, which will support the organisation's clients in accessing services.

For this practical, as a group, please examine and discuss the user personas in the appendix, covering example MH4U services:

- Adult mental health recovery;
- Counselling; and
- Employee wellbeing.

Use your group understanding and consensus on the user personas to help guide your thinking about how MH4U and its services could be digitally transformed.

SWOT Analysis

"SWOT Analysis is a useful technique for understanding your Strengths and Weaknesses, and for identifying both the Opportunities open to you and the Threats you face. What makes SWOT particularly powerful is that, with a little thought, it can help you uncover

opportunities that you are well placed to exploit. And by understanding the weaknesses of your organisation, you can manage and eliminate threats that would otherwise catch you unawares. More than this, by looking at yourself and your competitors using the SWOT framework, you can start to craft a strategy that helps you distinguish yourself from your competitors, so that you can compete successfully in your market."[1]

Helpful tutorial video can be found here: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=I_6AVRGLXGA

For MH4U, your group needs to go around each of the four areas and analyse the **strengths**, **weaknesses**, **opportunities** and **threats**. It's recommended to write several bullet points or paragraphs of text for each of the four areas using the MIRO template.

Note that strengths and weaknesses are internal aspects of your idea, while opportunities and threats are seen as external to the idea. For this reason a SWOT analysis is sometimes called an inside-outside analysis of a business/idea/concept.

Your task in this practical

Your task in this practical is to work together as a group to:

1. Read the background information about the fictitious metal health charity, called MH4U;
2. Explore the user personas developed for MH4U in the appendices of this document;
3. Read the background on the SWOT analysis technique;
4. From your understanding of what is meant by digital transformation, carry out a SWOT analysis of a digital transformation of MH4U and its services; and
5. Create a SWOT analysis diagram based on the Miro SWOT analysis template[2].

Resources

Please read this article to help understand the concept of digital transformation of mental health services:

- Bond, R.R., Mulvenna, M.D., Potts, C. et al. Digital transformation of mental health services. npj Mental Health Res 2, 13 (2023). https://doi.org/10.1038/s44184-023-00033-y

[1] https://www.mindtools.com/amtbj63/swot-analysis
[2] https://miro.com/templates/swot-analysis/

Appendix – User personas for MH4U

1 – Adult mental health recovery services

Moira Watson

AGE	47
EDUCATION	Bachelors in Business
STATUS	Divorced Parent
OCCUPATION	Sales Manager
LOCATION	Portadown
TECH LITERATE	Medium

> I am an adult living with depression. I am seeking a sense of fulfillment and community, while learning new skills and coping mechanisms.

Personality

Artistic | Thinker

Bio

Moira battles depression due to the strains of raising her 16-year-old daughter, Sarah, and managing work demands. This internal struggle clouds her motivation and creativity with a persistent sense of sadness and isolation, leading her to withdraw from her art community and friends. Moira's aspiration to reconnect with her daughter and rediscover her creative spark is hindered by the weight of her depression, despite past attempts at therapy and medication. Though hopeful for a path to healing, the journey ahead feels overwhelming.

Core needs

- Overcome her depression and regain a sense of joy and purpose in her life.
- Strengthen her relationship with her daughter, Sarah, and provide her with the emotional support she needs during her formative years.
- Reconnect with her creative passions.
- Build a support network of friends who understand and empathise with her struggles.

Frustrations

- Overcoming the stigma associated with mental health issues and seeking help openly.
- Balancing her work, parenting responsibilities, and self-care without feeling overwhelmed.
- Finding an effective treatment plan for her depression that works for her unique needs.
- Rebuilding her self-esteem and confidence, which have been eroded by her prolonged struggle with depression.

Services

Supporting the recovery of adults experiencing mental ill health who are interested in progressing towards further education, training or employment.

Interests

Yoga | Photography

2 – Counselling services

Sarah Roberts

AGE	34
EDUCATION	A Level
STATUS	Civil Partnership
OCCUPATION	Data Processing
LOCATION	Belfast
TECH LITERATE	Low

> I am an adult with anxiety hoping to challenge my current thought processes and learn new coping techniques.

Personality

Attentive Anxious

Bio

Sarah grapples with severe anxiety impacting her personal and professional life. Amidst demanding deadlines and a busy lifestyle, her anxiety often overwhelms her, hindering her focus. Driven by a desire for a more fulfilling life, Sarah is determined to challenge her thought processes and develop healthier coping mechanisms. She recognizes the need to replace irrational anxious thoughts with balanced thinking through therapy and self-help resources. Sarah's journey includes mindfulness techniques, medication, and exercise, aiming to reduce anxiety symptoms. She's also open to seeking specialised therapy for support in managing her anxiety more effectively.

Core needs

- Challenge and reframe negative thought patterns that fuel her anxiety.
- Develop a toolkit of coping strategies that help her manage anxiety in different situations.
- Improve her ability to focus on her work and engage fully in her professional responsibilities.
- Strengthen her overall emotional resilience and wellbeing.

Frustrations

- Overcoming the fear of judgment or stigma associated with anxiety.
- Consistently implementing new coping techniques and integrating them into her daily routine.
- Consistently implementing new coping techniques and integrating them into her daily routine.

Services

High quality counselling services

Interests

Cooking Scrapbooking

3 – Employee wellbeing services

Jenny Campbell

AGE	42
EDUCATION	Management HND
STATUS	Married
OCCUPATION	Regional Manager
LOCATION	Ballymena
TECH LITERATE	Medium

> I am a manager hoping to increase my understanding of mental health issues so I can better support my employees, and foster a positive and supporting environment.

Personality

Confident | Empathetic

Bio

With a track record of successful leadership, Jenny's dedicated to driving team success and organizational goals across multiple branches. Beyond her professional achievements, Jenny's proactive focus extends to learning more about mental health to better support her employees facing challenges. Recognising the connection between mental wellbeing and productivity, she aims to create an environment where conversations about mental health are encouraged, stigma is reduced, and resources for support are readily available. She is determined to foster an inclusive workplace that prioritizes mental health and ensures employee comfort in seeking help and sharing concerns.

Core needs

- Deepen her understanding of mental health to better support her employees facing mental health challenges.
- Foster an inclusive and empathetic work environment where employees feel safe discussing their mental wellbeing.
- Provide resources and access to mental health support for her team members.
- Lead by example, demonstrating a healthy work-life balance and self-care practices.

Frustrations

- Balancing her demanding role as a regional manager with her personal growth journey.
- Overcoming potential resistance to open discussions about mental health in a professional setting.
- Ensuring that her efforts to support mental wellbeing are genuine and effective for her diverse team.

Services

Specialised mental wellbeing training and consultancy to tackle workplace mental ill-health.

Interests

Book Club | Running